

Lemon Aleura / Lilith — Illusions Affinity Strings

Rules for the draft

- **TP / DC** are proposed balancing values, not established canon. **CTR, THS, and POT** are the suggested Thread Check attributes.
- An illusion changes **perception**, not physical reality. It cannot hold a door shut, catch a falling person, conjure a usable card, alter gambling odds, or make a weapon harmless.
- A person with a reason to doubt an effect can make an **ACU check against its listed DC**. Convincing physical evidence—such as a hand passing through an apparent solid wall—reveals the relevant deception without requiring repeated checks. An observer who has identified it can tell others, giving them Harmony on their check.
- **Her casting has a musical-chime signature**. Different Strings may carry different little phrases of chimes, as suggested in the chat, but changing the melody does not remove the recognizable signature.
- These are **sensory illusions**, not her father's Dream Affinity or her mother's Emotion Affinity. They do not rewrite memories, implant desires, or compel obedience.
- A distracting effect generally causes **Discord on one specified action**; it does not automatically make a target take the action Lemon wants.

Later PLs are possibilities for growth. They should not be read as a list of everything she can already do at nineteen.

1. The Companion String — CTR

Awakening String. Lemon presents a person so vividly that conversation with them seems possible. The first expression was private and unrecognized: a boy's voice at the lake, then the boy himself. A Companion can appear to have a personality, but cannot bring Lemon information she has no way of knowing or exert physical force.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	A single apparent person is visible and audible to Lemon alone for a scene of up to 10 minutes . She can perceive their movements and converse with them. They cannot move objects or physically block anyone.

		This is the scale of her first incident, though its spontaneous recurrence was not a conscious ten-minute cast.
2	2 / 13	She can deliberately present the Companion to one other creature within 20 ft for 3 rounds , or keep the self-perceived version for 1 hour . It can speak in a voice she can imagine, but cannot answer a question using facts she does not possess.
3	4 / 15	Up to three observers within 30 ft can perceive the same person for 1 minute . Lemon can direct its position and speech while attending to the scene. If an observer tries to touch it, its apparent body offers no physical resistance.
4	6 / 17	The Companion can hold a coherent conversation with up to six observers for 10 minutes while Lemon concentrates. She need not supply every word aloud, but its improvisation still draws on her knowledge, expectations, and characterization—not an independent mind.
5	9 / 19	She sustains one fully coordinated Companion

		across a 60-ft area for 1 hour while concentrating, allowing different observers to see and hear it from their own positions. A proved contradiction or attempted physical interaction can still expose it.
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Limit: Convincing someone that a person is present is not the same as making that person physically present. **Companion never creates a real implement**, even if the figure appears to offer one.

2. The Chime String — THS

Sound without a visible source. Lemon can place footsteps, a voice, a knock, or a small tune in the wrong part of a room. This is separate from the chimes that identify *her* magic: the false sound is an effect; the casting signature is its tell.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 10	Produces one brief sound—such as a footstep, card tap, or whispered word—within 20 ft . It can draw a glance or reinforce a harmless performance.
2	2 / 12	Sustains an apparent sound source within 30 ft for 1 minute . A listener following it has Discord on their next hearing-based check to locate Lemon.
3	4 / 14	Places up to three distinct sound sources across a 40-ft area for 3 rounds : approaching boots, a call for help, or a conversation heard through a door. Listeners can still check

		whether the sounds fit the room.
4	6 / 17	Shifts the apparent location of an existing voice or noise for 1 minute while concentrating. One creature relying on it for direction must pass an ACU check or move toward the false source on its next voluntary move. It can choose not to move at all.
5	8 / 19	Conducts a layered soundscape over a 60-ft area for 10 minutes . She can guide an evacuation with apparent calls from several positions, or confuse pursuers; a soundscape cannot suppress real speech or her own casting signature.

Limit: An illusory cry for help can cause a real person to respond. Lemon remains responsible for where she leads them.

3. The Card String — CTR

Small, exact object illusions. A playing card is the natural teaching tool: its face, edge, position, and timing all matter. Lemon's deck is **real**. This String changes what someone sees in or around it, not what is actually in their hand.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Changes the apparent face of one visible card or similarly small object for 1 minute . Handling it or comparing it against a trusted reference may

		expose the illusion.
2	2 / 13	Displays up to three illusory small objects within 20 ft for 3 rounds . They can look like cards, coins, or keys, but nothing can be taken from their apparent position.
3	4 / 15	Alters the apparent faces or arrangement of a real hand of cards for 10 minutes . This can support a bluff or a demonstration; it does not change the cards, the deal, or the odds.
4	6 / 17	Maintains a convincing collection of up to twenty small apparent objects within 30 ft for 10 minutes , accounting for viewing angle and overlap. A searcher trusting the false arrangement has Discord on one check to find a real item among them.
5	9 / 19	Gives several observers distinct apparent views of the <i>same</i> small set of objects for 3 rounds —useful for a sophisticated distraction or staged reveal. Once the observers compare notes or physically examine the objects, the contradiction becomes evidence.

Limit: No invisible card enters a deck and no false coin pays a debt. Using this String to cheat carries ordinary social and legal consequences.

4. The Glamour String — CTR

Change how someone appears. Glamour can alter the perceived color and cut of clothing, obscure a distinctive feature, or build a convincing persona. It does not change the wearer's body, voice, height, or actual garments unless combined with other Strings.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Alters one small visible feature on herself—hair color, an accessory, or a stain—for 10 minutes . Touch or close inspection can reveal the unchanged material.
2	2 / 13	Changes the apparent colors and broad style of her outfit for 1 hour . It must fit roughly over what she is actually wearing; a bulky coat cannot convincingly become bare arms at close range.
3	4 / 15	Disguises one willing person within 20 ft for 1 hour , matching a plausible build and clothing silhouette. Impersonating a specific person still requires knowledge of their mannerisms and voice.
4	6 / 17	Glamours up to three willing people for 1 hour , maintaining consistent appearances as they move together. Once each may gain Harmony on a check to pass at a glance; a conversation or physical

		inspection remains a real test.
5	9 / 19	Maintains a detailed appearance on herself or one willing person for 8 hours while awake, responding to ordinary lighting and movement. The wearer does not acquire the identity, credentials, or memories of whoever they resemble.

5. The Sensation String — THS

An apparent touch, temperature, or texture. This accounts for why an illusion might *feel* present without giving it hands that can actually move anything. Sensation can comfort or distract; it cannot restrain, wound, heal, or replace real contact.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Gives herself a brief harmless impression of warmth, a breeze, or a surface texture. She can use it to study how convincing a projected sensation feels.
2	3 / 14	Gives one willing creature within 10 ft a brief impression of touch or temperature. This can reinforce a performance or soothe a tense moment, but does not change the actual temperature.
3	5 / 16	Projects a harmless sensory impression to one unwilling

		creature within 20 ft. On a failed ACU check, the surprise gives it Discord on its next concentration or perception check. It does not force a decision.
4	7 / 18	Coordinates sight, sound, and apparent texture for up to three creatures for 3 rounds . A false wall might seem cold at first contact, but someone leaning on it still passes through.
5	10 / 20	Maintains a coherent set of benign sensory impressions throughout a 20-ft area for 1 minute while concentrating. People can perceive a place as warmer, quieter, or softer than it is; they remain exposed to its real hazards.

Limit: Feeling safe is not *being* safe. Lemon cannot use this String to remove an injury or make dangerous surroundings harmless.

6. The Reflection String — CTR

A person in two apparent places. Reflection produces doubles and afterimages. Unlike Companion, it copies the movements or appearance of an existing person rather than sustaining a separate conversational character.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Leaves a stationary afterimage of Lemon for 1 round . One observer has Discord on its next sight-based attempt to follow her movement.

2	2 / 13	Creates one moving double within 10 ft for 3 rounds . It mirrors her general movement; its feet cannot press grass or open a door.
3	4 / 15	Creates up to two doubles within 20 ft for 3 rounds . The first attacker each round who relies on sight must pass an ACU check or target a double instead; that attack reveals that particular double.
4	6 / 17	Reflects one willing ally rather than herself, or divides a group's apparent movements among up to three doubles for 3 rounds . Observers can still track real sounds and physical interactions.
5	9 / 19	Sustains a shifting set of up to five afterimages across 30 ft for 1 minute while concentrating. Once a round, one sight-dependent attack against a protected ally has Discord; the effect does not stop an area attack.

Limit: A double can make someone miss. It cannot step in front of a blade and *take* the hit.

7. The Curtain String — CTR

Conceal a real thing by presenting its surroundings differently. Curtain is the String a guard uses to cover an exit, hide a vulnerable person, or keep a document out of casual view. It cannot erase sounds, scent, footprints, or the physical outline of something being touched.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Makes one small stationary object blend into its background for 1 minute . Someone searching that exact spot at arm's length may notice the mismatch.
2	2 / 13	Conceals a willing, still person against nearby scenery for 3 rounds . They have Harmony on one check to avoid visual notice until they move or speak.
3	4 / 15	Hides a doorway, cache, or two still people across a 10-ft area for 10 minutes while concentrating. It changes the visible scene; the actual doorway remains passable.
4	6 / 17	Keeps up with one willing moving person for 3 rounds . Sight-based attacks against them have Discord until the observer locates them through movement, sound, or other evidence.
5	9 / 19	Covers a 20-ft area and its occupants for 1 minute , maintaining plausible scenery as people move through it. It can protect an evacuation from distant eyes, but cannot hide a crowd's footsteps or the chimes of Lemon casting.

Limit: Concealment is not invisibility to every sense.

8. The Stage String — THS

Set a scene. Stage changes the apparent surroundings: a wall, a furnished room, a clear hallway, or the view beyond a window. It is powerful for a social encounter or controlled escape, but a false route is dangerous if someone trusts it over the real floor beneath them.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Changes the appearance of one 5-ft surface for 10 minutes : a painted sign, plain wall, or different view through a window. The actual surface stays where it is.
2	3 / 14	Alters the appearance of a 10-ft section of a room for 3 rounds , furnishing it with stationary details. An observer moving through can reveal where apparent furniture is absent.
3	5 / 16	Stages a 20-ft room or passage for 10 minutes while concentrating, including appropriate light and broad ambient sound. She must know the real obstacles well enough not to send allies into them.
4	7 / 18	Presents a coherent 40-ft scene to up to six observers for 10 minutes , adjusting its perspective as they move. Physical interaction and observations made outside

		the staged area remain independent evidence.
5	10 / 20	Stages a 60-ft area for 1 hour while concentrating, complete with moving background details. It can convincingly host a meeting or conceal an operation, but cannot make a nonexistent staircase bear weight.

Limit: At twelve Lilith thought the drop outside her window seemed to deepen. The story leaves room for frightened perception; I would **not** declare that moment an earlier Stage cast when the chat identifies meeting Aries as her first magical incident.

9. The Misdirection String — POT

Put the most convincing detail in the wrong place. Misdirection steers attention through a flash, motion, face, or sound. It does not control a person's thoughts or force them to believe Lemon.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 12	Draws one observer's eye toward an apparent flicker within 15 ft . On a failed ACU check, it has Discord on its next check to notice a different visible detail before Lemon's next turn.
2	2 / 14	Combines an apparent movement and sound within 20 ft . One observer that fails an ACU check loses its Reaction until its next turn while it checks the wrong position.
3	4 / 16	Draws the attention of up to three observers toward a

		chosen point within 30 ft for 1 round . It creates an opening for an ally to move; the ally still needs a possible physical route.
4	6 / 18	Sustains a shifting distraction across a 20-ft area for 3 rounds . Once each round, one affected creature has Discord on a sight-based attack or search check of Lemon's choice.
5	9 / 20	Orchestrates a convincing diversion for up to ten observers within 40 ft for 3 rounds . Each can test the illusion when its details conflict with reality; a direct warning from an unaffected observer grants Harmony on that test.

Limit: Choosing to investigate a sound is the observer's choice. Lemon cannot use this String to make someone betray a friend, disclose a secret, or harm themselves.

10. The Labyrinth String — CTR

Alter apparent routes and distances. Labyrinth makes the familiar seem unfamiliar. Lemon's experience of being confined makes its best use an important choice: it can delay a threat, but it can also guide someone toward a **real** way out.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 12	Makes one turn in a visible passage appear slightly earlier or later for 1 round . A hurried pursuer failing an ACU check loses 5 ft of movement correcting

		course.
2	3 / 14	Presents a false continuation or obscures one real turn within 20 ft for 3 rounds . A creature relying on sight must check or spend its next movement approaching the wrong route. It stops at a real wall.
3	5 / 16	Reframes paths across a 30-ft area for 1 minute . Lemon may leave one clearly marked true route visible to chosen observers while pursuers see a plausible detour.
4	7 / 18	Maintains a shifting apparent route across a 60-ft area for 3 rounds . A creature failing its ACU check has its movement halved as it repeatedly corrects course; nothing physically restrains it.
5	10 / 20	Guides a group through a 120-ft mapped area for 10 minutes , presenting a true route to allies and false turns to pursuers. Lemon must actually know a traversable route. Labyrinth cannot lead someone through solid stone.

Limit: This is never teleportation. It changes the map people think they see, not the ground beneath them.

11. The Seam String — THS

Learn where an illusion stops matching reality. Lemon's control improves when she can test her own work instead of accepting the most comforting version of it. Seam helps her inspect and dismantle illusions; it is not universal truth-sight or a counter to every Affinity.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	1 / 11	Identifies the edge and extent of one illusion she is presently controlling . She can end it cleanly without leaving an accidental afterimage.
2	2 / 13	Studies a suspected illusion within 20 ft for 1 round . Gain Harmony on one ACU or THS check to identify its sensory inconsistency or magical weave.
3	4 / 15	Points out a discovered seam to up to three allies , giving them Harmony on their first check against that particular illusion. She may also end several of her own minor illusions at once.
4	6 / 17	Contests one visible Illusion String of PL 4 or lower within 30 ft with an opposed Thread Check. Success exposes or suppresses it for 1 round ; it does not dispel unrelated magic.
5	9 / 19	Holds a 20-ft clarity field for 3 rounds while concentrating. Allies within it have Harmony on checks against sensory illusions; on a successful opposed

		check Lemon can end one Illusion effect crossing the field.
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Limit: Seam cannot tell Lemon whether a person is sincere. It also cannot simply turn off her father's dreams or her mother's emotional influence: those are different powers.

12. The Horizon String — THS

An entire possible scene, shared with others. Horizon is the mature form of the promise at the lake—but with a vital difference: Lemon knows she is showing people an image, not taking them to another world. Its strongest use may be letting others imagine a way forward while keeping the real exit in view.

PL	TP / DC	Effect
1	2 / 13	Presents herself with a brief, immersive view of another place she knows or can imagine for 1 round . She remains aware of her actual location if she casts deliberately.
2	4 / 15	Shares a simple scene with one willing person for 1 minute : what a room could look like, the route she intends to take, or a story she wants to show. It conveys an image, not a memory proven true.
3	6 / 17	Shares a coordinated sight-and-sound scene with up to three willing people within 20 ft for 3 rounds . This can rehearse a rescue or communicate a plan when ordinary explanation is too slow.
4	8 / 19	Overlays a detailed

		alternate scene on a 30-ft area for 1 minute while concentrating. Unwilling observers can test it; willing observers may use its marked real route to gain Harmony on one coordinated movement check.
5	11 / 21	Holds a coherent, multisensory apparent world across a 40-ft area for up to 10 minutes , presented to up to ten people . Lemon can guide their attention or tell a story within it. She cannot transport them, remove their real injuries, or prevent them from choosing to leave.

Limit: Horizon is not “a world without pain.” It is an illusion Lemon controls well enough to **tell people what is illusion** and help them act in the real world.